

Strategic Growth

1. Internal Strengths

- a. What special skills, expertise or knowledge do we have that are unique?

- b. Do we have any special “bell cows”, alliances, testimonials or leveragable relationships in our customer list or network of contacts and associates which could influence groups of potential buyers?

c. What are our core strengths/competency? What are we especially good at doing that is valuable and unique?

d. Competitively, why do customers buy from us? Why isn't this strength sufficient to cause more potential buyers to stop doing business with our competition and to start doing business with us?

e. What is the key positioning statement or compelling promise of our brand?

f. What is the excess capacity we currently have or excess resources we currently enjoy that are under utilized?

2. Environment-Competition-Market

- a. Different buyers have different outcomes, priorities and definitions of “Success”. Segmenting this broad market into specific groups is critical to understanding where we will focus and prioritize our resources. What are the various market segments within our broader market and what are the common characteristics of each? *(You should answer each of the questions in this section for each of the different segments you identify in this first question.)*

- b. What are the primary pains within this market? Where are they frustrated by the gap between what they are currently getting and what the competition is delivering? What specific problem do they need to have solved?

c. What is the primary gain this target market wants to get? What is the motivating need? How do they define (specifically) “Success”?

d. What are the specific concerns or fears or friction points that must be addressed or mitigated to cause a potential customer to start doing business with us? What is the frictionless, compelling reason for them to switch to us?

e. Where is our competition weak or deficient in delivering the outcomes and value (“success proposition”) the market demands?

f. What is the one thing that would be the difference that makes the difference for each segment of the market and would cause this segment to buy from us?

g. Who are the decision makers and what is the best way to access and communicate with them? Are there any unique circumstances or market segments that would require special communication or decision making considerations?

h. Are there any attractive market segments that could be more easily penetrated as a result of segment clustering (“birds of a feather....”)?

3.Opportunity

- a. Based on our internal leveragable strengths and the external competitive environment, what are the specific, ripe market segments we have identified as an ideal target customer? How is this target different from our current customer base?

- b. What are the critical challenges and primary obstacles that we must overcome to successfully transition from where we are to this new opportunity?

c. What are the additional resources (money, manpower, skill-sets, marketing, expertise) we will need to acquire to successfully get traction with this market segment? Does our organization chart have some holes/upgrades that need to be filled in light of this new strategic growth initiative?

d. What risks does this new opportunity represent? What could go wrong? How much capital needs to be invested to adequately fund this opportunity? How do these risks compare with the returns anticipated?

e. What is the clear positioning statement and compelling promise that will be communicated to the target market segment? What are the additional communication channels required to successfully reach the decision makers?

f. What are the core activities which must be prioritized to insure the success of this growth initiative? What are the non-core activities which need to be eliminated or deprioritized?

g. What are the clear strategic priorities (projects) that must be implemented this quarter? What are the specific numerical targets that will be achieved?

Unsold Buyer (NO):

1. What **Risks** does the unsold buyer perceive that would prevent them from making the switch? (How can we give them “Certainty of Success”?)

2. What **Friction** points would the unsold buyer have that would prevent them from buying?

3. What is the **DIFFERENCE** that makes the **DIFFERENCE** to the unsold buyer?

4. How (specifically) does the unsold buyer define
“Success”?

Buyers (Yes):

5. What must happen for this target to say “YES!”?

6. What must happen to keep them coming back for
seconds?

7. What must happen for them to become addicted and refer?
